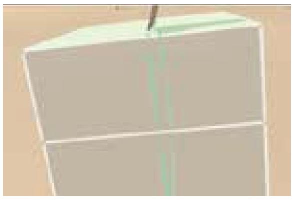
ment first. To group shapes together, all you need to do is press the red button which resides on the face of your main controller. Note that the grouped objects will turn slightly transparent. You can now move or resize these objects together. To ungroup the objects, simply hit the red button again.

AVOID THE CREATION OF EXTRA TRIANGLES

Google recently added a bunch of highly requested features in the Labs menu. You can find this at the very bottom of the Blocks menu as a beaker icon. One of the features is non-coplanar face mode. For those who have already used Blocks, you must have noticed that Blocks creates coplanar faces when it reshapes meshes. This is usually helpful in many cases, however, sometimes it may create extra triangles even when they are not needed. These make operations like perfect subdivision very difficult. With a recent update, you can enable non-coplanar faces which avoids the entire conundrum altogether.

USE LOOP SUBDIVISION

Subdivision is a really powerful tool, especially in apps like Google Blocks where you are dealing with 3-dimensional objects. Therefore, loop subdivision is even more powerful since it can actually divide the object in a loop which surrounds the entire mesh. Say you have a huge project, it would be enormously time-consuming and tiring to create accurate divisions in 3D objects which wrap around its entire surface area. Blocks now has loop subdivision. To use this you can simply long press on your trigger while you are subdividing which will form a perfect subdivision loop all around the object.



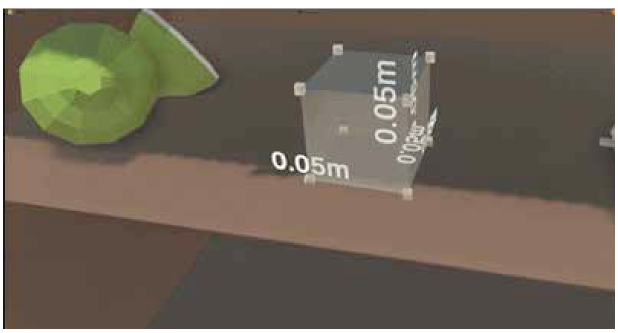
Cut a loop around an entire mesh easily

DELETE A SINGLE EDGE, FACE OR VERTEX

In the early versions of Google Blocks, you could not delete a single edge, face or vertex which meant that you had to delete an entire component if you made a single, small mistake. The ability to delete single edges, faces and vertexes was recently added to Google Blocks. You need to use the eraser tool to do this and Blocks will 'collapse' the mesh based on the particular edge, face or vertex you delete.

VOLUME INSERTION RULER

For many, modelling 3D objects precisely in Blocks can be quite complicated if you don't have a sense of relative scale. The volume insertion ruler feature allows users to enable a ruler when you insert an object. You will see relative measurements in metres on each axis. Now you can precisely and accurately measure objects in relation to other objects that you have created in Google Blocks.



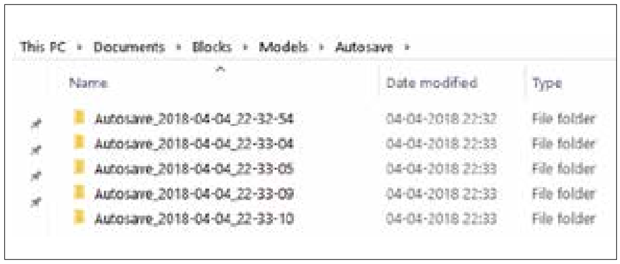
Accurately measure objects in relation to others with the volume insertion tool

EXPANDED MESH WIREFRAME

Google Blocks users are accustomed to the feature where you get a helpful wireframe while reshaping a mesh around the exact section of the mesh you are altering. However, many users asked Google for the ability to turn that wireframe on for the entire mesh instead of just one section of it. Google Blocks recently got the feature where you can do exactly that by accessing an expanded mesh wireframe. This allows users more control over the smallest points in their 3D creations.

USE AUTOSAVES

Google Blocks actually autosaves your progress from time to time and many users do not actually know this until they dig through their PC files. We have all been witness to occasional crashes, lags and power cuts in many games and software. Then you mope around because you have lost all the data that you possibly spent hours working on. Simply go to Documents in your PC and then find Blocks. Within Blocks, you will find Models and then go to Autosave. To load the autosaves, open Blocks, type ctrl - D to open the development console and then type 'loadfile (file path to the saved .blocks version of the saved model).



This PC › Documents › Blocks › Models › Autosave ›

Name	Date modified	Type
Autosave_2018-04-04_22-32-54	04-04-2018 22:32	File folder
Autosave_2018-04-04_22-33-04	04-04-2018 22:33	File folder
Autosave_2018-04-04_22-33-05	04-04-2018 22:33	File folder
Autosave_2018-04-04_22-33-09	04-04-2018 22:33	File folder
Autosave_2018-04-04_22-33-10	04-04-2018 22:33	File folder

Autosaves can be a real lifesaver

GRIP SNAPPING

Grid snapping is very important when you want your 3D models to be lined up in an accurate manner. This is especially important when normal snapping of 3D objects will not do the trick. However, grid snapping being kept on does restrict you while creating models, so you should usually only turn it on when you require the additional functionality it offers. However, when you want to snap new objects you create directly to points, grid snapping can make your life much easier than normal snapping. It allows for more angular and precise shapes like robots or buildings.

*Would you like a Level Up dedicated to getting started with Google Blocks specially catered for beginners? Let us know at **editor@digit.in**.*